LFH Case No. 536[1]

Bradford, Wisc.
Sept. 20, 74

Dear Friend Ettie

Your welcome epistle was recd. last evening. It was a real surprise to me for I had not thought that you would answer for several weeks. I knew you would have a great deal to do with what little strength you had & therefore made great allowance. But I'm glad to find you so prompt.

What a wretched substitute this pen is for my tongue. I've only two weeks after this tank [illegible]. (p. 2) Mrs. H. thinks I will need my sallary raised in order to pay my Posts & stationery bills. I do write many letters but some how I can not bear think of dropping any of my correspondents on account of the stamps. I must tell you why I write on this price of a sheet. Tis'nt because I have no more but it's all I have here at school.

After noon

I have just returned from dinner and so have a few moments will improve them. I'm real glad your health is better & hope it will continue to improve. I am very healthy & fleshly indeed some might think I did not work; on account of my health being so good, but then; I do you know. I hope I shall get home in season to see those people before they go to Cal.[2]; for I have some word to send to my people, if they (p. 3) should be there in that part of the state. Yes Ettie I try to do some good in this busy world of ours, but really you place me to high. So you know it is not well to think a person so honest these days (I am true to you how ever) & am glad you do call me a true friend for that I want to be.

I know it must be real hard for you to part with F. for you seem to be all that are left & of coarse are much to each other. But then Dear Ettie you must try & look at the silver lining which you know the dark clouds have & some times I think that darker they are the more brilliant is their lining. (P. 3)

LFH Case No. 536

1 The month is "Sept" and the year appears to be "74," but the day has so much crossover writing it is illegible. See: *1874 9 16 Letter - Emma Thayer To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, 078*.

2 "Cal" could be "California." Best transcription.

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California is not so very far away after all & if his health improves he will probably return in a year or two you must not feel to blue & forsaken for you have many good friends & you know it is all for the best & you must try to be resigned thinking, yes trusting that in
Gods good time you'll meet if not in this in a far better land. Do I hear you say Em's in the Pulpet? well that's just where she is & I rather think it does make her feel a little like Sermonizing but then you can not blame her when take in consideration the abundance

Emma continues the letter, cross lettering in the top margin of page 1.

of time she has. I have thought it a great pity that she had no talent for writing a book might just as well have been written as not.
I am making a basket-quilt shall not finish it this term I fear. The mornings are getting quite short
I am coming to see you and hear all about certain affairs when I get home. have not heard from home for some time in fact have herd only once since I came down. They evidently do not intend to weary me with their much speaking..[3]I will finish this tomorrow Adieu for today. Business is business you know I promised to finish this letter today but I have very little energy some how. As our hired girl always says I don't feel any more life than a stick. There are strong questions that I'd like answers I never.[4] ask but must wait as I feel sure you

Emma's letter continues along the far right edge of page 1 and then upside down on the top edge of page 1.

would most want me to ask [illegible] then other than verbally

Emma continues her letter writing upside down on the top margin of page 4.

I am to have more scholars the rest of the term & I'm not sorry. Have six today & more coming tomorrow The people have sprouted quite a number but they ar'nt large enough for me to sprout yet wish they were. Mr. White has gone to the Junction (Milton Junction?) & I hope to get some letters to night. I forgot that I said I should not

Emma's letter continues upside down on the top edge of pages 2 and 3.

write another letter this week I've written four already but then I'm so

3 "Speaking" best transcription.
4 "Never" best transcription.

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pressed with business no wonder I forget & tell a story.[5] once in a while.
64 You will have time to write once more & I want you to improve it. Do
you hear! P.S. Guess I've said it all

Emma's letter continues on the left edge of page 2, top to bottom.

66 Ever your own true Emma. Return[6] you like me to sign my name.

5 "Story" best transcription.
6 "Return" could be "Retire."

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LFH Case No. 536. 20 September 1874 Letter Emma Thayer, Bradford, Wisconsin, to Juliette A. E. Flagler, Janesville, Wisconsin..[7] Data: 1 letter sheet; 1 letter written; Author's sex F; 1 author; author's age 99; Env.; No Return address on env.; $ .03 green stamp "G.W."; Front postmark, "city-illegible, month-illegible, 25, state-illegible"; No Back postmark; No postmark time; Cursive; Purple Ink; Not embossed; blue-lined; No watermark; No letterhead; No complimentary close; No separate signature line; No postscript; Thayer; Written Sunday; TOD unknown; Fall; 12.5 x 20.1 cm ((4.92 x 7.91 in); 1 date; Doc. cond. good; Legibility poor; cotton-fibre; Wotim; Yes Crossing Letters; Heading; Per. informal greeting; No separate signature line.

Emma begins by thanking Ettie for her epistle received last evening, and that she was surprised because she didn't expect a reply for "several weeks." On line 8 she writes, "I knew you would have a great deal to do with what little strength you had & therefore made great allowance. But I'm glad to find you so prompt.".[8] In Thayer's second paragraph she writes what "a wretched substitute this pen is for my tongue" and that she only has two weeks more of this "tank torture." Emma says that a "Mrs. H." thinks Emma will need her salary increased to pay for her postage and stationery. Emma admits to writing "many letters," but refuses "dropping any of my correspondence" because of the cost of stamps. She tells Ettie why she writes on this "price of a sheet," and it isn't because she has no more, but it's all available "here at school." After Emma breaks for lunch as a school teacher, she continues her letter "After Noon," telling Ettie that she is glad Ettie's health is better and hopes "it will continue to improve." Emma speaks of her health writing, "I am very healthy & fleshly indeed some might think I did not work; on account of my health being so good, but then; I do you know." Emma hopes that she will get home "in season to see those people before they go to Cal," because she wants to send "word...to my people, if they should be there in that part of the state." Emma tells Ettie that she tries "to do some good in this busy world of ours, but really you place me so high." She states that "it is not well to think a person so honest these days (I am true to you how ever) & am glad you do call me a true friend for that I want to be." In Thayer's fourth paragraph she speaks of Ettie's status writing, "I know it must be real hard for you to part with F. for you seem to be all that are left & of coarse are much to each other. But then Dear Ettie you must try & look at the silver lining which you know the dark clouds have & some times I think that darker they are the more brilliant is their lining." "F's" relationship to Ettie is clarified as Emma writes, "you seem to be all that are left & of coarse are much to each other." On page three Emma reveals who "F" is: "California is not so very far away after all & if his health improves he will probably return in a year or two you must not feel to blue & forsaken for you have many good friends & you know it is all for the best & you must try to be resigned thinking, yes trusting that in Gods good time you'll meet if not in this in a far better land." Thayer then asks Ettie: "Do I hear you say Em's in the Pulpet? well that's just where she is & I rather think it does make her feel a little like Sermonizing but then you can not

7 The date is an estimate since Emma's cross-lettering makes it difficult to determine the year.

8 The question of Juliette Flagler's health is mentioned several times in the Flagler-Campbell Epistolary. What Ettie's illness or diagnosis was has not been determined.

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LFH Case No. 536. blame her when take in consideration the abundance of time she has. I have thought it a great pity that she had no talent for writing a book might just as well have been written as not.".[9] Emma tells Ettie she making a basket-quilt but it won't be completed by the end of the school term and adds, "The mornings are getting quite short." As Thayer continues her letter, cross-lettering on the margin of page one, she tells Ettie that she is coming to see her and ask her all "about certain affairs when I get home." She also admits that she hasn't heard from home "for some time in fact have herd only once since I came down." Emma writes, "They [her family] evidently do not intend to weary me with their much speaking." She tells Ettie she will finish the letter tomorrow ("Adieu for today") as "Business is business you know." She then apologizes for not finishing the letter today, "I have very little energy some how. As our hired girl always says I don't feel any more life than a stick." Thayer tells Ettie that she "strong questions that I'd like answers I never.[10] ask but must wait as I feel sure you would most want me to ask [illegible] then other than verbally." Emma continues her letter upside down in the margin of page four, telling Ettie she is going "to have more scholars the rest of the term & I'm not sorry." She states she has six today and more coming tomorrow and then writes, "The people have sprouted quite a number but they ar'nt large enough for me to sprout yet wish they were." Emma ends her letter mentioning: that a "Mr. White" is going to the Junction and she hopes to get more letters tonight; that she forgot that promised not to write another letter this week, even though she had written "four already"; that she is so pressed "with business no wonder I forget & tell a story.[11] once in a while"; and tells Ettie that she [Ettie] will have time to "write once more & I want you to improve it. Do you hear!" Her postscript reads: "P.S. Guess I've said it all. Ever your own true Emma. Return.[12] you like me to sign my name." Juliette Flagler received a letter dated 8 September 1876 in which Emma Thayer describes her transcontinental rail journey from the Midwest to Sonoma County, California. Emma would teach in California. See: See: Emma J. Thayer wrote eight letters to Juliette A. E. Flagler: *1872 4 9 Letr. Emma Thayer to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 061*; *1873 12 3 Letr. Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 62*; *1874 9 16 Letter - 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, 078*; *1875 2 22 Letr. Emma J. Thayer 'E.J.F.' to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 095*; *1875 3 14 Letr. 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 099*; and *1874 9 20 - Letter Emma Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 536*; *1876 9 8 Letter Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 132*; and *1879 5 3 Letter - Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 186*.

9 The identity of "Em" has to be researched.
10 "Never" best transcription.
11 "Story" best transcription.
12 "Return" could be "Retire."

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